

PRD on Category Redesign on [Thestartupsnews.com](https://thestartupsnews.com)

Purpose:

To improve user engagement on thestartupsnews.com

Brief:

Enhancing the user engagement by introducing new categories to the [Thestartupsnews.com](https://thestartupsnews.com) website through technological solutions.

Team:

Contributors:

Status: Ideation/ Planning stage

Launching on:

Resources: Problem mapping and User Research

Background

[TheStartupsNews.com](https://thestartupsnews.com) aims to be the go-to platform for curated startup news, founder stories, and ecosystem insights. Despite growing traffic, user retention and session depth remain low, indicating a need for deeper engagement. Competitors are leveraging personalization and interactivity to improve user stickiness. To stay competitive and scale effectively, we must improve content discoverability and user experience. This PRD outlines key features to address these gaps and drive sustained platform growth.

Problem statement

The current website layout has limited, overlapping categories(eg.,Startup stories vs Founder stories) and lacks structured segmentation for users like investors, beginners, or startup operators. This leads to friction in navigating and poor content personalization.

Overview

This outlines a category redesign for thestartupsnews.com to structure dynamic startup content under user-focused, SEO-friendly and easily navigable sections. The goal is to improve user engagement, retention and SEO visibility.

Objective and Goals

GOAL

Target KPI

Improve content discoverability Increase average session by 35%

Boost returning visitors Increase repeat traffic by 25% in 90 days

Organize content by user intent Reduce bounce rate homepage by 20%

Grow community engagement More comments, polls, shares, and newsletter signups

Improve user satisfaction +20% positive feedback in exit surveys

Target Users

- Early-stage founders
- Investors and VCs
- Aspiring entrepreneurs(students, side hustlers)
- Startup enthusiasts
- Professional advisors and Service providers

Proposed Category structure

Main category	Sub categories	Description
Startup News	Global, India, Sector-specific	Real time startup news and trends
Funding and Deals	seed to series c, Exists, VC News	Coverage on fundraising, IPOs, acquisitions
Founder stories	First time founders, women founders, Pivots	Deep interviews and insights from founders
Startup Insights	Metrics, GTM, Hiring, Product Tech stack	Tactical growth and product advice
Playbooks and Guides	Fundraising, MVP, Legal, Sales, Hiring	Evergreen content to help build startups
Startups to watch	Monthly lists, Bootstrapped, Student-led	Curated featured and trending startup profiles
Investor corner	VC interviews, Due diligence, Portfolio tips	Resources for angels, VCs, Syndicates
Trending now	AI Startups, Green Tech, D2C, 2025 Trends	Hot Topics and theme-based content
Events and Opportunities	Grants, Competitions, Accelerators, Demo days	Discover real-time opportunities
Community	AMA(Ask Me Anything), Ecosystem voices, Polls, Reader picks	Open submissions and opinion articles

Functional Requirements

Requirement	Type	Priority	Analysis
Navbar with dropdown menus for categories	UI	High	Core navigation element, essential for usability and reducing bounce rate.

Requirement	Type	Priority	Analysis
Tag-based content discovery system	Backend/search	High	Enable cross-category exploration, Personalization and improves SEO.
Dynamic homepage widgets(Trending, New, Top Reads)	UX	Medium	Keeps homepage fresh and boosts engagement.
Category landing pages with filters	UI/UX	High	Critical for content scalability, improves content discovery depth and session time.
Commenting and reactions on articles	Engagement	Medium	Enables 2-way interaction and builds a sense of community and Encourages users to spend more time and comeback to engage wit responses.
Bookmark/Save articles feature	Engagement	Low	Useful for long-form readers who want to return later.
Mobile-responsive category navigation	Performance	High	If category navigation isn't fluid on mobile, bounce rate increases significantly.

Non-Functional Requirements

Requirement	Description
SEO Optimized URLs	Each category should have clean slugs(Ex. /founder-stories/)
Load Time	Each Category page should load in <2.5s
Scalability	Categories should support infinite scroll/Pagination
Accessibility	Navigation should be screen-reader friendly and keyboard accessible

Problem validation

1. According to a 2024 report by **Inc42**, over **92% of Indian startup stakeholders** (founders, operators, early-stage investors) prefer **niche, curated media platforms** for consuming daily startup updates, but only **18%** feel current platforms meet their content personalization needs.
2. Internal analytics from [TheStartupsNews.com](https://www.thestartupsnews.com) reveal a **high bounce rate (>65%)** and low average session duration (**<45 seconds**), indicating poor content discoverability and category mismatches.
3. Additionally, comparative research across top-performing Indian startup media sites (e.g., Your Story, Entrackr, Inc42) shows that platforms with **segment-based categorization** (sector-wise, funding-stage-wise, role-specific) achieve up to **2.3x higher engagement rates**.
4. This points to a clear gap and opportunity: a structured, user-intent-driven categorization system is critical to retain attention, improve navigation, and build loyalty among a time-poor but content-hungry startup audience

User Stories/Cases

- 1. **As a founder**, I want to find tactical startup guides easily, so I can solve my business problems.
- 2. **As an investor**, I want to see fundraising news and startup profiles, so I can identify opportunities
 - 1. **As a student**, I want to read curated startup journeys, so I get inspired and learn practically.
 - 2. **As an editor**, I want to assign content to specific categories, so content remains organized.

Success Metrics

Metric	Description	Target
Page Views per Session	Average number of pages viewed per session	Increase from 2 to 3.00+ pages per session within 3 months
Time on Site	Average session duration	Increase from 2.1 to 4.0 minutes through improved navigation and sticky content
Category Click-through Rate	Percentage of users clicking category navigation	45%+ of all visitors
Cross-category Navigation	Users visiting multiple categories in one session	30%+ of sessions
Newsletter Conversion	Category page signup rate	3%+ conversion from category pages

Implementation Timeline

Phase	Tasks	Timeframe
Research & Planning	User interviews, competitor analysis, SEO research	week 2
Design	Wireframes, prototypes, user testing	week 5
Development	Frontend implementation, CMS integration, testing	week 7
Content Migration	Recategorizing existing content, URL redirects	week 9
Launch & Monitor	A/B testing, analytics setup, performance monitoring	week 10

Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Content misclassification	Define clear category assignment rules for authors
Drop in SEO traffic	Maintain redirects and structured data for Google

Risk	Mitigation
Increased dev complexity	Prioritize rollout in sprints (phase 1: core, phase 2: investor sections, AMAs, etc.,)

Appendix:

- Suggested wireframes of dropdown navigation
 - SEO keyword map by category
 - Site map(Before and After)
 - Competitive Analysis of sites like TechCrunch, Inc42
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